

Chapter 36-1

Xu Qingzhu's fever came without warning, like a sudden summer rain—arriving swiftly and with fierce intensity.

Afraid that Xu Qingzhu's high fever might not subside and burn her brain, Liang Shi didn't dare delay for even a moment. She called the butler and told him to summon the family doctor.

The spacious living room was filled with heat.

Xu Qingzhu lay back on the sofa, feeling hot. She had already unbuttoned two buttons of her shirt but still felt it wasn't enough, so she continued reaching down to unbutton more, revealing the white lace underneath.

Liang Shi hurriedly pressed down on her hands, afraid she would directly remove her outer shirt.

But Xu Qingzhu opened her hazy eyes, tilted her head to one side, and murmured, "Liang Shi."

Liang Shi immediately responded, "I'm here."

Xu Qingzhu said, "You're pressing on me."

Liang Shi: "..."

Looking down, she saw that her hand was indeed resting on the back of Xu Qingzhu's hand, right at the position of the third shirt button.

Combined with Xu Qingzhu lying crooked on the sofa, her shirt had already shifted out of place.

The shirt button was right at her right chest area.

That place was soft and burning hot, like cotton candy that was melting.

It was so hot it made one's mouth dry.

This directly startled Liang Shi into shivering.

She immediately let go, explaining, "I-I-I... didn't mean to... to offend."

She stuttered so much she could barely complete a full sentence.

But Xu Qingzhu turned her face and smiled. Her body was too burning hot, so she needed something cool to bring down the temperature, and the person beside her was the perfect choice.

She reached out and touched Liang Shi's neck, gaining a bit of relief.

Liang Shi felt her carotid artery continuously transmitting heat, as if it would burn her entire being.

Helplessly, she took Xu Qingzhu's hand away, "I... I'll go get you... get you an ice towel."

She got up, but her hand was pulled by Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu was already thin to begin with, and after being too busy at the company recently, she had become even more gaunt. Her long hair hung loosely, some falling on her chest, some on the sofa.

Her face was as if dyed with cherry blossom pink, especially her lips, which were redder than the most tender spring roses, but they had lost moisture. She stuck out the tip of her tongue and lightly licked them, from the edge to the lip bead. Her thoughts were probably already somewhat scattered as she bit her lip, leaving a tooth mark on her originally bright red lips.

Her two legs were casually draped on the sofa, her upper body rising and falling irregularly, making her look very uncomfortable.

"Want ice," Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi frowned, "No, you have a fever."

"Ice," Xu Qingzhu still insisted. She lay there with her eyes half-closed, her lips opening and closing, revealing white pearly teeth.

Liang Shi: "...Then let go of me."

But Xu Qingzhu, after pausing for two seconds, moved her hand to Liang Shi's cooler wrist. After absorbing some coolness, she finally let go, her whole body going limp.

Liang Shi went to the refrigerator to get ice cubes, but didn't give them to her directly to eat. She found a clean towel and wrapped the ice cubes in it to help her cool down.

Having a fever meant her whole body was burning hot. Only her forehead felt slightly better, which couldn't make her entire person feel refreshed.

But it was much better than before.

Liang Shi tried to keep some distance from her, but couldn't completely avoid physical contact.

Her fingers would accidentally touch Xu Qingzhu's forehead, or lightly brush across her nose tip. When Xu Qingzhu felt her nose itch and scrunched it up, Liang Shi would become extremely nervous.

Xu Qingzhu felt physically uncomfortable and curled up on the sofa, not wanting to talk, looking pitiful.

Liang Shi simply prepared two towels—one on her forehead and one for her to hold in her hands.

But Xu Qingzhu didn't have the strength to hold it, so Liang Shi placed that one at her collarbone. Xu Qingzhu then pulled her hand to move it down a bit more.

When the family doctor arrived with the butler, the two of them were huddled together on the sofa in a strange and peculiar position.

The butler had originally called out, "Third Miss."

But after seeing the scene before him, he consciously turned around.

But Liang Shi immediately said, "Come over quickly and take a look."

After the doctor's diagnosis, it was high fever caused by overwork combined with catching cold. A few IV drips and some anti-inflammatory medicine would do the trick.

Since IV treatment was confirmed, Xu Qingzhu naturally had to be taken upstairs to her room.

But Xu Qingzhu's mind was currently muddled and she had almost no consciousness, let alone being able to walk.

In the end, it was Liang Shi who carried her up.

Alphas had great strength. Before carrying her, Liang Shi had given herself some mental preparation and secretly whispered in Xu Qingzhu's ear, "I'm going to carry you now, I don't have any bad intentions."

Xu Qingzhu mumbled something, but her voice was too quiet to make out what she said.

As Liang Shi carried her upstairs, Xu Qingzhu rubbed her head randomly in Liang Shi's embrace.

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The normally short distance suddenly felt like it would never end.

When she placed Xu Qingzhu on the bed, Liang Shi secretly wiped the sweat from her temples.

This was indeed a very torturous thing.

The doctor set up the IV for Xu Qingzhu and left several boxes of medicine.

Afraid of any problems, Liang Shi had the butler rest in the building behind them so he could be called upon at any time.